

Microsoft 365 Copilot Analytics

Attribute Reference

Complete attribute mapping, data classification, and naming conventions for organisational data

Document Property	Value
Section	Reference
Audience	IT Admin, Insights Admin
Version	4.1
Last validated	16 July 2026

How This Document Fits

This is a **Reference** guide. Use it when preparing CSV uploads or configuring HRIS connectors. For the step-by-step upload process, see the Data Onboarding Guide.

Section	Purpose	Who Reads
Strategy	Decide what to implement	CIO, SA, Business Leaders
Setup	Configure and deploy	IT Admin, Insights Admin
Operate	Use dashboards and reports daily	Leaders, Analysts, Managers
Reference (you are here)	Look up details and fix issues	Everyone (as needed)

Table of Contents

1. Attribute Mapping Table
2. Requirements and Source Precedence
3. Data Classification
4. Naming Conventions
5. Reserved Attribute Names
6. Update, Delete, and Historical Correction
7. Microsoft Learn References

1. Attribute Mapping Table

This table maps Viva Insights organizational-data names to the **Organizational Data in Microsoft 365** reserved names used in the Microsoft 365 admin center. Use the names required by the active tenant path and target app; do not infer the path from a date alone.

Legacy Name (Viva Insights)	M365 Admin Center Name	Required?
PersonId	Microsoft_PersonEmail	Platform required
ManagerId	Microsoft_ManagerEmail	Required for Viva Insights / Copilot Dashboard
Organization	Microsoft_Organization	Required for Viva Insights / Copilot Dashboard
EffectiveDate	N/A (date picker in UI)	Tenant-path dependent
FunctionType	Microsoft_JobDiscipline	Optional
LevelDesignation	Microsoft_LevelDesignation	Optional
Location	Microsoft_CompanyOfficeLocation	Optional
HireDate	Microsoft_HireDate	Optional
HourlyRate	Microsoft_HourlyRate	Optional
Layer	Microsoft_Layer	Optional
SupervisorIndicator	Microsoft_SupervisorIndicator	Optional
Custom (e.g., BusinessUnit)	Custom (same name)	Optional

Source: Organizational Data in Microsoft 365 — requirements (Microsoft Learn, updated 2 December 2025) defines `Microsoft_PersonEmail` as the platform requirement and the app matrix; Manage settings for the Microsoft Copilot Dashboard, Agent Dashboard, and Viva Insights web app (20 March 2026) defines the three Dashboard/Viva attributes.

2. Requirements and Source Precedence

Surface / attribute	Requirement or precedence
Organizational Data in Microsoft 365	Microsoft_PersonEmail is required. Additional attributes depend on the sele
Copilot Dashboard and Viva Insights	Microsoft_PersonEmail , Microsoft_ManagerEmail , and Microsoft_Organ
Microsoft 365 User Profile	Microsoft Entra is the default source. Uploaded organizational data can be prio
Viva ManagerId and Organization	Parallel ingestion can select Entra as the default for either attribute while uploa
Multiple upload sources	Microsoft documents merged Dashboard data with the more recent upload tal

Sources: Organizational Data in Microsoft 365 — Data precedence (Microsoft Learn, updated 2 December 2025); Manage settings for the Microsoft Copilot Dashboard, Agent Dashboard, and Viva Insights web app (20 March 2026); and Use Microsoft Entra plus .csv files for parallel data uploads (visible date 30 June 2025; content refreshed 7 July 2026).

3. Data Classification

When uploading organisational data, each attribute is assigned an access classification that controls which applications and roles can read the data.

Classification	Visibility
Public	Well-known organizational attributes made available to Microsoft 365 Profile and accessible to tenant users.
Confidential	Sensitive well-known attributes for which the uploader chooses the apps that can receive the data.
Custom	Tenant-defined attributes with controls for choosing which apps can access the data.

Best Practice

Set `HourlyRate` and any compensation-related attributes to **Confidential**. Set demographic attributes like `Organization`, `Location`, and `FunctionType` to **Public** so they are available as dashboard filters.

Source: Organizational Data in Microsoft 365 (Microsoft Learn, updated 2 December 2025) defines public, confidential, and custom organizational data and app access controls.

4. Naming Conventions

Rule	Details
Use underscores, not spaces	Column names must not contain spaces. Use <code>Business_Unit</code> or <code>Busi</code>
No <code>Microsoft_</code> prefix for custom attributes	The <code>Microsoft_</code> prefix is reserved for system attributes. Custom column
Case sensitivity	Attribute names are case-insensitive during upload but are stored as p
Maximum length	Attribute names should not exceed 128 characters.
Total attribute limit	Maximum of 105 total attributes per upload (reserved system attribute
Avoid special characters	Use only letters, numbers, and underscores. Avoid hyphens, periods, and

5. Reserved Attribute Names

The following attribute names are reserved by the system and **cannot be used for custom attributes**. If you need a similar concept, use a different name (e.g., `Agency_Location` instead of `Location`).

Reserved Name (Legacy)	Reserved Name (M365 Admin Center)
PersonId	Microsoft_PersonEmail
ManagerId	Microsoft_ManagerEmail
Organization	Microsoft_Organization
EffectiveDate	N/A (UI-based)
FunctionType	Microsoft_JobDiscipline
LevelDesignation	Microsoft_LevelDesignation
Location	Microsoft_CompanyOfficeLocation
HireDate	Microsoft_HireDate
HourlyRate	Microsoft_HourlyRate
Layer	Microsoft_Layer
SupervisorIndicator	Microsoft_SupervisorIndicator

Important

Any custom attribute name beginning with `Microsoft_` will be rejected during validation. If you need to add custom attributes with similar concepts, use your own naming convention (e.g., `Agency` , `CostCentre` , `Region`).

6. Update, Delete, and Historical Correction

Organizational Data in Microsoft 365 uses incremental merge. Upload only affected users and include attributes you intend to update. An omitted or blank value preserves the existing value; use the documented marker when a value must be deleted.

Data type / operation	Supported value or path
Delete string value	Two single quotes (' ') in CSV; three single quotes when editing through E
Delete integer value	-1
Delete email value	A nonexistent email in the tenant, for example noname@contoso.com
Delete date value	01-01-0001
Correct historical data	CSV Historical import with the appropriate File valid as of date; Microsoft
Restore Entra for Viva hierarchy attributes	Enable ManagerId and/or Organization under Configure Entra connec

No Dummy-Row Workaround

Do not use a one-row “Replace All” file as a general rollback. It can create an artificial hierarchy and disrupt filters, partitions, and reports. Use the supported operations above or Microsoft Support for a critical migration rollback.

Sources: Import and manage your organizational data with a .csv file — Update or make other changes and Make retroactive updates (Microsoft Learn, updated 2 April 2026); Use Microsoft Entra plus .csv files for parallel data uploads — FAQs (visible date 30 June 2025; refreshed 7 July 2026).

7. Microsoft Learn References

Topic	Link
Organizational Data in Microsoft 365	learn.microsoft.com/viva/organizational-data
CSV import, update, delete, and historical correction	learn.microsoft.com/viva/import-orgdata
Parallel Entra and uploaded data	learn.microsoft.com/viva/insights/advanced/admin/entra-plus-cs
Org Data Attribute Reference	learn.microsoft.com/viva/insights/advanced/admin/org-data-ove
Prepare Organisational Data (CSV)	learn.microsoft.com/viva/insights/advanced/admin/prepare-org-
Validation Errors	learn.microsoft.com/viva/insights/advanced/admin/rules-validati
Data Quality Page	learn.microsoft.com/viva/insights/advanced/analyst/data-quality

Disclaimer: This document is provided for informational purposes only and was last validated on 16 July 2026. Microsoft may change features, interfaces, and availability without notice. Verify Microsoft Learn, Message Center, and the live tenant UI before implementation. This document is not official Microsoft documentation and should not be treated as a definitive source for product capabilities or licensing requirements.